

Russell Kwong

Research Assistant

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Education

B.Sc. Cornell University, Urban and Regional Studies Ithaca, NY
 • Honors Thesis: Fleeing Climate Hazards: Evidence from U.S. Domestic Migration Sept 2021 – May 2025
 1990-2022

Experience

Katz Lab, Research Assistant Ithaca, NY
 Built a database of 7 million street trees in 600+ cities to answer phenology and remote sensing questions. June 2025 – present
 1 year 1 month

- "TreePoint, a database of urban trees in the eastern and midwestern United States [in review]"
- "Changes in the health-related ecosystem services and disservices provided by urban trees over multiple decades in a small city [in preparation]"

Cornell University Center for Cities, Research Assistant Ithaca, NY
 Analyzed data to assess the effectiveness of climate vulnerability indices in measuring social vulnerability. Feb 2025 – Jan 2026
 1 year

Cornell University Sustainable Design, Sustainability Researcher Ithaca, NY
 Policy researcher to promote citywide carbon neutrality practices to meet the City of Ithaca Green New Deal. Feb 2022 – Jan 2025
 3 years

- "Driving Ithaca to Carbon Neutrality with Curbside Composting" (Dec 2023)
- "Curbside EV Charging Proposal for the City of Ithaca, NY" (May 2022)

NYC Department of City Planning, Population Research Intern New York, NY
 Wrote an automation script in ArcPy to generate 29 demographic characteristic maps for the Newest New Yorkers 2026 June 2024 – Aug 2024
 3 months

- Wrote and compiled scripts using the ArcGIS API to enhance web map sharing and customization across the agency
- "The Newest New Yorkers: A Statistical Portrait of Foreign-born Residents and Their Role in Shaping the City's Population (2026 edition)"

Program on Applied Demographics, Demographics Research Assistant Ithaca, NY
 "Population density maps for New York State counties" (Feb 2024) Dec 2021 – Mar 2024
 2 years 4 months

- "New York State geographic primer" (Sep 2023)
- "Atlas of Urban Areas in New York State" (Mar 2023)
- "Counties and County Subdivisions in New York State" (Aug 2022)

Publications

Counties and County Subdivisions in New York State Aug 2022
 White paper atlas of reference maps on counties and county subdivisions for each of the 62 counties in New York State.

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pad.human.cornell.edu/maps2020/maps/ReferenceMaps.pdf (Program on Applied Demographics)

Atlas of Urban Areas in New York State

Mar 2023

White paper atlas of urban areas in New York State.

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pad.human.cornell.edu/maps2020/maps/UrbanAreas2020.pdf (Program on Applied Demographics)

New York State geographic primer

Sept 2023

This primer outlines the terminology and codes you need to work with these geographies and provides descriptions and examples of each geography type. This geographic primer was written to help New York State data users to easily manage and understand commonly published geographic entities and state-specific areas and terminology.

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pad.human.cornell.edu/papers/downloads/NYS_GeographicPrimer_2023.pdf (Program on Applied Demographics)

Population density maps for New York State counties

Feb 2024

White paper atlas of county level population density maps in New York State.

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pad.human.cornell.edu/maps2020/maps/PopulationDensityAtlas2020.pdf (Program on Applied Demographics)

Fleeing Climate Hazards: Evidence From U.S. Domestic Migration 1990-2022

May 2025

This paper explores associations between the environment, especially climate hazards, and domestic migration using publicly available data from 1990-2022.

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ecommons.cornell.edu/entities/publication/b4a6e85d-bd97-4d7d-bb33-5662afee137b

Changes in the health-related ecosystem services and disservices provided by urban trees over multiple decades in a small city

Feb 2025

This paper tracks health-related ecosystem service provisions by street trees as a function of the changing citywide tree population and ambient environmental conditions over 77 years in Ithaca, NY.

Russell Kwong, Thomas E. Victor, Noa Dijstelbloem, Zhou Y. Dong, Ava M. Robillard, Willa A. Gagnon, Christina S. Simon, Camille I. Radhakrishnan, Keily A. Peralta, Elan C. Youngstrom, Emma C. Terjesen, Maia Tsignadze, Daphne Okuyama, Moheng Ma, Daniel S.W. Katz

[10.1101/2025.02.21.639397v1](https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.02.21.639397v1) (bioRxiv)

Best 50 Hikes in and Around Ithaca NY

Apr 2026

The book is a comprehensive guide to hiking in the Ithaca region covering more than 240 miles of trails in and near Tompkins County.

Myra Shulman, Russell Kwong

cayugatrailclub.org/buy-guidebook (Cayuga Trails Club)

TreePoint, a database of urban trees in the eastern and midwestern United States [in review]

May 2026

A street tree database of over 7 million trees in across 600 cities in the eastern and midwestern US. This publicly available database can be used to answer questions relevant to tree management, ecology, and evolution across broad spatial and climatic scales.

Russell Kwong, David L. Miller, Alexander R. Young, Conor McMahon, Hannah Zonneville, F.D. Cowett, Daniel S.W. Katz

zenodo.org/records/19581904 (Scientific Data)

The Newest New Yorkers: A Statistical Portrait of Foreign-born Residents and Their Role in Shaping the City's Population (2026 edition)

June 2026

This book provides a comprehensive portrait of immigrants in New York City. It examines the countries of origin of the city's foreign-born, their patterns of residence, their demographic and socioeconomic characteristics, the legal paths of entry of newly admitted immigrants, the role of the foreign-born in the New York region, and finally assesses the demographic impact of immigrants on the city.

New York City Department of City Planning, Arun Peter Lobo, Eric Ketcham, Donnise Hurley, Eric Maurer, Stephen Wolkwitz, Joel Alvarez, *Russell Kwong*, Mariel Martinez Ledezma
www.nyc.gov/content/planning/pages/our-work/reports/newest-new-yorker (City of New York)

Skills

Spatial Analysis (advanced): Spatial Statistics, Econometrics, ArcPy, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, Land Suitability, Cartography

Data Analytics (intermediate): RStudio, Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, Microsoft Excel

Presentation and Graphics (advanced): Report writing, Adobe Creative Suite, Affinity Design, SketchUp

Volunteer

Learning Unlimited, Graphic Designer

June 2025 – present